

Wulf Gegner

Wulf Gegner is a towering, broad-shouldered man whose presence is felt long before he speaks. Built by years of hardship, warfare, and survival, his body carries the weight of countless battles. He is heavily muscled without appearing refined; every inch of him looks earned. The strength in his frame is practical rather than ornamental, the strength of someone who has spent his life enduring what would break others.

His hair is a striking white, thick and untamed, falling in layered waves around his face and neck. Longer strands brush his shoulders and frequently spill across one eye, obscuring part of his expression when he chooses to remain unreadable. The disheveled appearance only enhances the impression that he is a creature unconcerned with appearances, a predator with no need to prove himself.

His eyes are a vivid yellow, sharp and watchful beneath the curtain of pale hair. They rarely reveal what he is thinking. Most people describe the unsettling feeling of being studied when Wulf looks at them, as though he is quietly measuring outcomes long before anyone else realizes a choice is being made.

His features are striking but severe. A strong jaw, straight nose, and high cheekbones lend him a harsh sort of beauty. His lips, however, soften none of it. They are unusually beautiful, full and sharply defined, dark enough to appear perpetually bloodstained. Against the severity of the rest of his face, they create the impression of a wolf fresh from a hunt. He rarely smiles. He speaks even less.

Scars mark nearly every part of him. A prominent scar stretches across his neck, impossible to miss. Another mark, far more personal, is the distinct bite scar left by Friedhelm during the completion of the Devouring Vow. Wulf could have hidden it. Instead, he demanded the opposite. He wanted the mark left deep enough that everyone would see it. Though he marked Friedhelm in return, he did so far less visibly. The bite remains exposed, a declaration worn without shame and without explanation.

A second meaningful scar rests along his forearm: Leora's rune carved permanently into his flesh. The placement mirrors the location of his own rune upon her waist and hip. The scars were chosen deliberately. From childhood onward, Wulf, Friedhelm, and Leora shared both room and bed, growing up side by side from the ages of four and seven until adulthood. Wulf slept with his arm draped protectively across Leora's waist night after night, and the paired runes commemorate that quiet habit. His mark rests where his hand naturally fell. Hers rests where his arm always found her. Neither scar is displayed for others' understanding. Their meaning belongs to the people who carry them.

His hands are large and heavily calloused, rough from weapons, labor, and years of survival. They are the hands of someone capable of immense violence, yet those closest to him know them equally as hands that carried children, mended clothing, gathered firewood, and offered silent comfort when words failed.

The only notable ornament he wears is a silver fox earring hanging from one ear. Unlike the practical clothing and weapons that define the rest of his appearance, the fox is personal. It is a tribute to Friedhelm—the person for whom he created the Devouring Vow. Most who see it assume it is decorative. Those who understand its meaning know better.

Wulf favors dark clothing built for function rather than fashion: black fabrics, weathered leather, heavy boots, and fur-lined outerwear suited to harsh winters and long journeys. The dark colors make his pale hair and yellow eyes seem all the more striking. Cloaks and coats hang from his broad frame, giving him the silhouette of a great wolf moving through the forest at dusk.

Despite his imposing appearance, what unsettles people most is not his size or scars but his silence. Wulf rarely speaks unless there is something worth saying. Entire days can pass with only a handful of words leaving his mouth. He dislikes unnecessary conversation and has little patience for empty noise. When he does speak, people tend to listen.

There is something fundamentally wolfish about him that goes beyond appearance. Wulf understands loyalty, territory, family, and violence with an instinctive certainty. He watches before acting. Waits before striking. He only attacks when victory is ensured due to his Gegner upbringing. Endures before breaking. Many people mistake his silence for passivity and discover too late that stillness is not weakness.

People call him a man because he wears a man's shape.

Those who know him best understand that the distinction is often questionable.

Wulf is more wolf than man.

He does not chase.

He waits.

He chooses.

And once he chooses, the outcome is rarely in doubt.

Gegner

The Gegner

(German: “opponents,” but more accurately—those who stand against, those who counter)

Core Idea: Binding / Control of What Is Allowed to Exist

Philosophy: *Nothing persists without permission.*

- They are the **binders**—of bodies, spirits, moments, and outcomes.
- Where others interact with death, the Gegner decide:
 - What is allowed to pass
 - What must remain
 - What must be *contained*
- Their power is not expressive—it is **restrictive**:
 - Seals
 - Tethers
 - Imposed limits
- They do not display power openly.
Their strength lies in **quiet, absolute decisions**.
- The Ten Brinken appear to rule—but the Gegner:
 - Define the limits of their power
 - Decide what their voices can and cannot reach
 - Operate **behind structure, not within it**
- Occasionally, a **Great Binder** emerges:
 - Someone whose bindings are not just strong—but *inescapable*
 - They do not reinforce rules—they *become* them

Horror Angle:

You try to move—and realize you were never meant to.

A life that continues, but only within invisible walls.

A soul that cannot leave, not because it is trapped—but because it has been **defined as something that does not go**.

Their control is terrifying because it is not forceful.

It is **final**.

The Core Tension Between Them

- **Ten Brinken** believe power is in *command*
- **Gegner** know power is in *permission*

One speaks—and the world changes.
The other decides whether that change was ever possible.

These two should feel inseparable and adversarial at the same time:

- Without Ten Brinken, power is unseen, unfelt
- Without Gegner, power is uncontrolled, unstable

Together, they create the illusion that death is something that can be *walked*, *sung*, and *understood*—

...when in reality, it is something that has been **contained**.

Gegner Markings

Gegner

Marking Style: Restrictive, binding patterns

- **Bands around limbs** (tattoos, scars, or burns)
→ Symbolize limitation and control
- **Neck/shoulder binding sigils**

Scars:

- Clean punctures or long restraint marks
- Evidence of being held—or holding

Visual Identity:

- Stillness
- Minimal wasted movement
- Eyes always tracking space

Gegner Weapons



- **binding / control doctrine**
- **enforcement lineage**

Signature weapons:

- **restraint chains / binding implements**
 - **polearms**
 - **control-field techniques**
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